Theme 4 title3 New Believer

26-11-07 21:48pm Sat

FROM CREATION TO THE CROSS
Understanding the Need for Jesus in Genesis
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you learn about the cross. You learn that Jesus died for your sins. You learn that He rose again. You learn that you are forgiven. It is wonderful. It is life-changing. It is the good news.

But then you might wonder, "Why did Jesus have to die? Why did there need to be a cross? What was the problem? Where did it all go wrong?" These are important questions. They are foundational questions. And the answers are found in the book of Genesis.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at the story of Genesis. We are going to see the problem. We are going to see the need. We are going to see why the cross was necessary. And we are going to see how the story leads from creation to the cross.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not be confused about why Jesus came. You will understand the problem. You will understand the need. You will understand the cross. You will see the story from creation to the cross. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the cross of Christ.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the promise. Read the proof. Read why it matters for your new life. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: Creation Was Good

The Promise (OT)
"God saw all that he had made, and it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day." - Genesis 1:31 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created everything. He created the heavens. He created the earth. He created the light. He created the land. He created the animals. He created humanity. He looked at it all. He saw it. He called it good. He called it very good. It was perfect. It was beautiful. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For since the creation of the world God's invisible qualities—his eternal power and divine nature—have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made, so that people are without excuse." - Romans 1:20

Jesus is the creator. He is the one who made everything. He is the one who called it good. The creation in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might wonder where to start. You might wonder what is true. Start here. Start with creation. God made everything. He made it good. He made it perfect. Your new life is built on the goodness of God.

Faith Builder
Go outside. Look at something beautiful. A tree. A flower. A sunset. Thank God for creating it. Thank Him for calling it good.

The Prayer
God, thank you for creation. Thank you for making everything. Thank you for calling it good. Thank you for calling it very good. Help me to see the goodness in your creation. Help me to see the goodness in my life. Amen.

Day 02: The First Command

The Promise (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a command. He gave a rule. He gave a test. He said, "You are free to eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. For when you eat from it, you will certainly die." It was a command. It was a boundary. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the command. He ate the fruit. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the command. He never sinned. He brought righteousness into the

world. The command in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are always breaking the rules. You might feel like you are always failing. You might feel like you are always disobeying. Remember Jesus. He obeyed for you. He kept the command for you. He brought righteousness for you.

Faith Builder
Think of a rule you struggle to keep. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus kept this rule for me." Thank Him for His obedience.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for obeying. Thank you for keeping the command. Thank you for bringing righteousness. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to live in your obedience. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 03: The First Sin

The Promise (OT)
"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The woman saw the fruit. She saw it was good. She saw it was pleasing. She saw it was desirable. She took it. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. They disobeyed. They fell. They sinned. It was the first sin. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned..." - Romans 5:12

Adam sinned. He brought sin into the world. He brought death into the world. He brought separation into the world. But Jesus did not sin. He brought righteousness. He brought life. He brought reconciliation. The first sin in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have sinned. You might have fallen. You might have made a mistake. Remember Jesus. He did not sin. He stood. He stood for you. He took your sin. He took your fall. He took your mistake. He gives you his standing.

Faith Builder
Think of a sin you have committed. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus took my sin. He gives me his righteousness." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for standing. Thank you for not sinning. Thank you for taking my sin. Thank you for taking my fall. Thank you for taking my mistake. Help me to stand in you. Help me to live in your righteousness. Amen.

Day 04: The First Shame

The Promise (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. Their eyes were opened. They realized they were naked. They were ashamed. They were afraid. So they sewed fig leaves together. They made coverings for themselves. They tried to fix their own problem. They tried to cover their own shame. It was a failed attempt. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the true covering. He is the true clothing. He covers our shame. He covers our sin. He covers our nakedness. The fig leaves in Genesis are a shadow. They are a clue. They are a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to cover your shame. You might be trying to hide your mistakes. You might be trying to fix yourself. Remember the fig leaves. They do not work. Remember Jesus. He is the true covering. He covers your shame. He covers your sin. He covers your nakedness.

Faith Builder
Think of a shame you are carrying. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus covers my shame." Crumple up the paper. Throw it away. Thank Jesus for His covering.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for covering me. Thank you for clothing me. Thank you for taking away my shame. Thank you for taking away my sin. Help me to stop sewing fig leaves. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 05: The First Fear

The Promise (OT)

"I heard you in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid." - Genesis 3:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam was afraid. He was afraid of God. He was afraid of being seen. He was afraid of being known. So he hid. He hid from God. He hid in the garden. He hid in the bushes. It was the first fear. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear, because fear has to do with punishment. The one who fears is not made perfect in love." - 1 John 4:18

Jesus is perfect love. He drives out fear. He takes away the punishment. He takes away the fear. The first fear in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be afraid. You might be afraid of God. You might be afraid of being seen. You might be afraid of being known. Remember Jesus. He is perfect love. He drives out fear. You do not have to hide. You can come out.

Faith Builder
Think of a fear you have. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Perfect love drives out fear. Jesus loves me perfectly." Thank Him for His love.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for perfect love. Thank you for driving out fear. Thank you for taking away punishment. Help me to stop hiding. Help me to come out. Help me to trust your love. Amen.

Day 06: The First Blame

The Promise (OT)
"The man said, 'The woman you put here with me—she gave me some fruit from the tree, and I ate it.'" - Genesis 3:12 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam blamed the woman. He blamed God. He blamed everyone but himself. It was the first blame. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"So then, each of us will give an account of ourselves to God." - Romans 14:12

Jesus is the one who takes responsibility. He is the one who pays the price. He is the one who takes the blame. The first blame in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tempted to blame others. You might be tempted to blame God. You might be tempted to blame yourself. Remember Jesus. He took the blame.

He took the responsibility. He took the punishment. You can stop blaming. You can receive His grace.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you blamed someone else. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus took the blame for me." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for taking the blame. Thank you for taking the responsibility. Thank you for taking the punishment. Help me to stop blaming others. Help me to receive your grace. Amen.

Day 07: The First Curse

The Promise (OT)
"So the LORD God said to the serpent, 'Because you have done this, cursed are you above all livestock and all wild animals! You will crawl on your belly and you will eat dust all the days of your life.'" - Genesis 3:14 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God cursed the serpent. He cursed the devil. He said, "Cursed are you above all livestock. You will crawl on your belly. You will eat dust all the days of your life." It was the first curse. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us, for it is written: 'Cursed is everyone who is hung on a pole.'" - Galatians 3:13

Jesus became a curse for us. He took the curse. He took the punishment. He took the death. The first curse in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel cursed. You might feel like you are under a curse. You might feel like you cannot escape. Remember Jesus. He became a curse for you. He took the curse. He set you free. You are no longer under the curse.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "Jesus became a curse for me. I am free from the curse." Say it out loud. Thank Him for His sacrifice.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for becoming a curse for me. Thank you for taking the curse. Thank you for setting me free. Help me to live in your freedom. Help me to live in your grace. Amen.

Day 08: The First Promise

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said, "I will put enmity between you and the woman. Between your offspring and hers. He will crush your head. You will strike his heel." It was the first promise. It was a hope. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the offspring. He is the one born of a woman. He is the one who crushed the serpent's head. He is the one who defeated the devil. The first promise in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the deliverer. He crushes the serpent's head. He defeats the devil. He gives you hope.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His promises.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Amen.

Day 09: The First Sacrifice

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made garments of skin. He made clothes. He made a covering. An animal had to die. Blood had to be shed. It was the first sacrifice. It was a gift. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the garment. He is the sacrifice. He is the covering. His blood was shed. His life was given. The first sacrifice in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covering. You might need a garment. You might need a gift. Remember the garments. Remember Jesus. He is the covering. He is the garment. He is the gift. He covers your shame. He covers your sin.

Faith Builder
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His righteousness. Thank Him for the gift of salvation.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the garment. Thank you for the covering. Thank you for the gift. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for giving your life. Help me to wear your garment. Help me to rest in your covering. Amen.

Day 10: The First Exile

The Promise (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God banished Adam from the garden. He sent him away. He exiled him. He drove him out. It was the first exile. It was a punishment. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our access. He brings us into grace. He brings us into peace. The first exile in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel exiled. You might feel banished. You might feel separated. Remember Jesus. He brings you back. He restores your access. He brings you into grace. He brings you into peace.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. Thank you for bringing me into peace. Help me to live in your presence. Help me to live in your grace. Amen.

Day 11: The First Murder

The Promise (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Cain was jealous. He was angry. He killed his brother. He shed innocent blood. It was the first murder. It was a tragedy. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the innocent one. He is the one who was killed. He is the one who shed his blood. The first murder in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have been hurt by someone. You might have been betrayed. You might have been wounded. Remember Jesus. He was hurt. He was betrayed. He was wounded. He understands. He heals.

Faith Builder
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for understanding my pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Thank you for being betrayed for me. Heal my wounds. Heal my pain. Heal my heart. Help me to forgive those who have hurt me. Amen.

Day 12: The First Blood

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Abel's blood cried out. It cried out for justice. It cried out for vengeance. It cried out from the ground. It was the first blood. It was a witness. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy. The first blood in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need forgiveness. You might need grace. You might need mercy. Remember the blood. Remember Jesus. His blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy.

Faith Builder
Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for your blood. Thank you for speaking a better word. Thank you for forgiveness. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. Help me to receive your forgiveness. Help me to live in your grace. Help me to extend your mercy. Amen.

Day 13: The First Flood

The Promise (OT)
"So God said to Noah, 'I am going to put an end to all people, for the earth is filled with violence because of them. I am surely going to destroy both them and the earth.'" - Genesis 6:13 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God saw the wickedness of the world. He saw the violence. He saw the sin. He decided to flood the earth. He decided to destroy it. It was the first flood. It was a judgment. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For as in the days of Noah, so will it be at the coming of the Son of Man." - Matthew 24:37

Jesus is the one who will return. He is the one who will judge. He is the one who will save. The first flood in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might see the wickedness in the world. You might see the violence. You might see the sin. Remember the flood. Remember the judgment. Remember Jesus. He is the one who saves. He is the one who rescues. He is the one who will return.

Faith Builder

Think of a time you felt overwhelmed by the wickedness in the world. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus is the one who saves." Thank Him for His salvation.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the one who saves. Thank you for being the one who rescues. Thank you for being the one who will return. Help me to trust you. Help me to live in your salvation. Amen.

Day 14: The First Ark

The Promise (OT)
"So make yourself an ark of cypress wood; make rooms in it and coat it with pitch inside and out." - Genesis 6:14 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God told Noah to build an ark. It was a boat. It was a rescue. It was a promise. God told him to build it. He told him to put rooms in it. He told him to coat it with pitch. He told him to save his family. It was the first ark.

The Proof (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the ark. He is the rescue. He is the salvation. He suffered for sins. He brought us to God. The first ark in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a rescue. You might need a salvation. You might need an ark. Remember the ark. Remember Jesus. He is the ark. He is the rescue. He is the salvation. He saves you from the flood.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a boat. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Thank Him for being your ark. Thank Him for saving you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being my ark. Thank you for being my rescue. Thank you for being my salvation. Help me to trust in you. Help me to live in your rescue. Amen.

Day 15: The First Covenant

The Promise (OT)
"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth." - Genesis 9:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Noah. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "Never again will all life be destroyed by a flood." It was the first covenant. It was a promise. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.'" - Luke 22:20

Jesus made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood." The first covenant in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to live in the new promise. Amen.

Day 16: The First Rainbow

The Promise (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God set a rainbow in the clouds. It was a sign. It was a promise. It was a reminder. It was a covenant. It was the first rainbow.

The Proof (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who judges. He is the one who saves. The first rainbow in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life

You are new to the faith. You might need a sign. You might need a promise. You might need a reminder. Remember the rainbow. Remember Jesus. He is the sign. He is the promise. He is the reminder. He is the one who saves.

Faith Builder
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the rainbow. Thank you for the sign. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for the reminder. Help me to see the rainbow. Help me to remember your promise. Help me to trust your covenant. Amen.

Day 17: The First Tower

The Promise (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The people built a tower. They built it with bricks. They built it with mortar. They built it to reach heaven. They built it to make a name for themselves. It was the first tower. It was a failure. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a name for himself. He did not build a tower. He did not reach heaven. He came down from heaven. He made a name for himself. He made a name that is above every name. The first tower in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to make a name for yourself. You might be trying to reach heaven. You might be trying to build a tower. Remember Jesus. He came down. He made a name. He made a name that is above every name. You do not have to build a tower. You do not have to reach heaven. You can just trust Jesus.

Faith Builder
Think of a way you have tried to earn God's love. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus already made a name for me. I can rest in Him." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for making a name. Thank you for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down. Thank you for reaching me. Help me to stop building towers. Help me to trust your name. Help me to live in your name. Amen.

Day 18: The First Call

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD had said to Abram, 'Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you.'" - Genesis 12:1 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God called Abraham. He told him to leave his home. He told him to leave his family. He told him to leave his country. He told him to go to a new land. It was the first call. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"Come, follow me," Jesus said, "and I will send you out to fish for people." - Matthew 4:19

Jesus calls us. He tells us to follow Him. He tells us to leave our old life behind. He tells us to go where He leads. The first call in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might hear a call. You might hear a voice. You might hear Jesus. He is calling you. He is telling you to follow Him. He is telling you to leave your old life behind. You can answer the call.

Faith Builder
Think of a step of faith you need to take. Write it down. Ask God to help you take it. Ask Him to help you follow the call.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the call. Thank you for calling me. Help me to answer the call. Help me to follow you. Help me to leave my old life behind. Amen.

Day 19: The First Blessing

The Promise (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing." - Genesis 12:2 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God promised to bless Abraham. He promised to make him a great nation. He promised to make his name great. He promised to make him a blessing. It was the first blessing. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the blessing. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The first blessing in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want to be blessed. You might want to be a blessing. You might want to make a difference. Remember the blessing. Remember Jesus. He is the blessing. He blesses you. He makes you a blessing.

Faith Builder
Think of one way you can be a blessing to someone this week. Write it down. Ask God to help you do it.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the blessing. Thank you for blessing me. Thank you for making me a blessing. Help me to bless others. Help me to make a difference. Amen.

Day 20: The First Faith

The Promise (OT)
"Abram believed the LORD, and he credited it to him as righteousness." - Genesis 15:6 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham believed God. He trusted God. He had faith. And God credited it to him as righteousness. Not because Abraham was perfect. Not because Abraham earned it. Because Abraham believed. It was the first faith. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"However, to the one who does not work but trusts God who justifies the ungodly, their faith is credited as righteousness." - Romans 4:5

Jesus is the object of our faith. We believe in Him. We trust in Him. And God credits it to us as righteousness. Not because we are perfect. Not because we earned it. Because we believe. The first faith in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might think you have to earn God's love. You might think you have to be good enough. You might think you have to work for it. Remember Abraham. He believed. That was enough. Your faith in Jesus is enough. It is credited to you as righteousness.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "I am made righteous by faith in Jesus, not by my works." Say it out loud. Thank God for this gift.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the gift of righteousness. Thank you that I do not have to earn it. Thank you that I do not have to work for it. Thank you that I just have to believe. Help me to trust in Jesus. Help me to live by faith. Amen.

Day 21: The First Covenant of Blood

The Promise (OT)
"On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram and said, 'To your descendants I give this land, from the Wadi of Egypt to the great river, the Euphrates...'" - Genesis 15:18 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Abraham. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "To your descendants I give this land." It was a covenant of blood. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance—now that he has died as a ransom to set them free from the sins committed under the first covenant." - Hebrews 9:15

Jesus is the mediator of the new covenant. He died to set us free. He made a new agreement. The covenant with Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need

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Day 21: The First Covenant of Blood (Continued)

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to live in the new promise. Amen.

Day 22: The First Test

The Promise (OT)
"Then God said, 'Take your son, your only son, whom you love—Isaac—and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.'" - Genesis 22:2 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God tested Abraham. He asked him to sacrifice his son. His only son. The son he loved. It was a test. It was a trial. It was a promise. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life." - John 3:16

Jesus is the only Son. He is the one who was given. He is the one who was sacrificed. The test of Abraham is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might wonder if God loves you. You might wonder if God cares. Look at the cross. Look at the sacrifice. God gave His only Son for you. That is how much He loves you.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "God loves me so much that He gave His only Son for me." Say it out loud. Thank Him for His love.

The Prayer
God, thank you for loving me. Thank you for giving your only Son for me. Thank you for the sacrifice. Thank you for the promise. Help me to trust your love. Help me to live in your love. Amen.

Day 23: The First Substitute

The Promise (OT)
"Abraham looked up and there in a thicket he saw a ram caught by its horns. He went over and took the ram and sacrificed it as a burnt offering instead of his son." - Genesis 22:13 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham looked up. He saw a ram. It was caught in a thicket. It was stuck. It was trapped. God provided the ram. God provided the sacrifice. It was a substitute. It was the first substitute. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, 'Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!'" - John 1:29

Jesus is the ram. He is the substitute. He is the sacrifice. He took our place. He took our punishment. The first substitute in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a substitute. You might need someone to take your place. Remember the ram. Remember Jesus. He is the substitute. He took your place. He took your punishment. He took your sin.

Faith Builder
Write down this truth: "Jesus took my place." Say it out loud. Thank Him for being your substitute.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the ram. Thank you for being the substitute. Thank you for taking my place. Thank you for taking my punishment. Thank you for taking my sin. Help me to live in your sacrifice. Amen.

Day 24: The First Provider

The Promise (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He saw God's provision. He saw God's faithfulness. He saw God's goodness. It was the first provider. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the provision. He is the one who meets our needs. He is the one who provides. The first provider in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have needs. You might have worries. You might have fears. Remember the provision of God. Remember Jesus. He meets your needs. He provides for you. He takes care of you.

Faith Builder
Think of a need you have. Write it down. Ask God to provide. Thank Him for being your provider.

The Prayer
God, thank you for your provision. Thank you for meeting my needs. Thank you for taking care of me. Help me to trust your provision. Help me to trust your faithfulness. Amen.

Day 25: The First Blessing of Nations

The Promise (OT)
"I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore." - Genesis 22:17 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will surely bless you. I will make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky. As the sand on the seashore." It was the first blessing of nations. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"If you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise." - Galatians 3:29

We are Abraham's seed. We are his descendants. We are part of the promise. The first blessing of nations in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are alone. You might feel like you do not belong. Remember the promise. Remember Abraham. You are part of a great family. You are part of the promise. You belong.

Faith Builder
Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the family. Thank you for making me part of your family. Help me to love my church family. Help me to serve them. Help me to belong. Amen.

Day 26: The First Faith of Abraham

The Promise (OT)

"By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going." - Hebrews 11:8 (Written around 60 A.D.)

Abraham had faith. He trusted God. He obeyed. He went. He did not know where he was going. He did not know what would happen. But he trusted God. He had faith. It was the first faith of Abraham.

The Proof (NT)
"Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways submit to him, and he will make your paths straight." - Proverbs 3:5-6

Jesus is the object of our faith. We trust in Him. We lean on Him. We submit to Him. He makes our paths straight. The first faith of Abraham in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might not know where you are going. You might not know what will happen. You might be afraid. Remember Abraham. He trusted God. He obeyed. He went. You can trust God too. You can obey. You can go.

Faith Builder
Think of a step of faith you need to take. Write it down. Ask God to help you trust Him. Ask Him to help you obey.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his faith. Help me to trust you. Help me to obey you. Help me to follow you, even when I do not know where I am going. Amen.

Day 27: The First Testing of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"Some time later God tested Abraham. He said to him, 'Abraham!' 'Here I am,' he replied." - Genesis 22:1 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God tested Abraham. He tested his faith. He tested his trust. He tested his obedience. It was the first testing of Abraham. It was a trial. It was a promise. It pointed to something greater.

The Proof (NT)
"Consider it pure joy, my brothers and sisters, whenever you face trials of many kinds, because you know that the testing of your faith produces perseverance." - James 1:2-3

Jesus is the one who helps us in our trials. He is the one who produces perseverance. The first testing of Abraham in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might face trials. You might face tests. You might face difficulties. Remember Abraham. He was tested. He trusted God. You can trust God too. He will help you. He will produce perseverance in you.

Faith Builder
Think of a trial you are facing. Write it down. Ask God to help you trust Him. Ask Him to produce perseverance in you.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his faith. Help me to trust you in my trials. Help me to trust you in my tests. Help me to trust you in my difficulties. Produce perseverance in me. Amen.

Day 28: The First Obedience of Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"Early the next morning Abraham got up and loaded his donkey. He took with him two of his servants and his son Isaac." - Genesis 22:3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham obeyed. He got up early. He loaded his donkey. He took his servants. He took his son. He went. He obeyed. It was the first obedience of Abraham.

The Proof (NT)
"If you love me, keep my commands." - John 14:15

Jesus is the one we obey. We love Him. We keep His commands. The first obedience of Abraham in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might wonder how to show your love for Jesus. You might wonder what to do. Remember Abraham. He obeyed. He showed his love by obeying. You can show your love by obeying. You can keep His commands.

Faith Builder
Think of one command of Jesus you can obey today. Write it down. Ask God to help you obey it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the example of Abraham. Thank you for his obedience. Help me to obey you. Help me to keep your commands. Help me to show my love for you. Amen.

Day 29: The First Provision of God

The Promise (OT)
"So Abraham called that place The LORD Will Provide. And to this day it is said, 'On the mountain of the LORD it will be provided.'" - Genesis 22:14 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

Abraham called the place "The LORD Will Provide." He saw God's provision. He saw God's faithfulness. He saw God's goodness. It was the first provision of God. It was a promise.

The Proof (NT)
"And my God will meet all your needs according to the riches of his glory in Christ Jesus." - Philippians 4:19

Jesus is the provision. He is the one who meets our needs. He is the one who provides. The first provision of God in Genesis is a shadow. It is a clue. It is a promise. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have needs. You might have worries. You might have fears. Remember the provision of God. Remember Jesus. He meets your needs. He provides for you. He takes care of you.

Faith Builder
Think of a need you have. Write it down. Ask God to provide. Thank Him for being your provider.

The Prayer
God, thank you for your provision. Thank you for meeting my needs. Thank you for taking care of me. Help me to trust your provision. Help me to trust your faithfulness. Amen.

Day 30: The Cross in Genesis

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

This is the first promise. This is the first gospel. This is the first clue. God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said a descendant would come. He said a hero would come. He said a rescuer would come. That descendant is Jesus. That hero is Jesus. That rescuer is Jesus. He is the cross in Genesis.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the promise. He is the fulfillment. He was born of a woman. He crushed the serpent's head. He defeated the devil. He saved the world. The cross in Genesis is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the fulfillment. He is the hope. He is the future. He is the cross in Genesis.

Faith Builder
Write down one thing you have learned about the cross in Genesis over the last 30 days. Thank God for the promise. Thank Him for Jesus.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the cross in Genesis. Thank you for the first promise. Thank you for the first gospel. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Thank you for saving the world. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Cross Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 days of the cross in Genesis. Now what? I challenge you to read the Gospel of John. It is 21 chapters. It is the perfect follow-up to this book. It shows you how Jesus is the fulfillment of every promise. As you read, look for the cross. Look for the clues. Look for Jesus.

A Note on Faith
The cross is evidence. It is evidence of a divine plan. But evidence does not save you. The cross points to a person. The cross points to Jesus. You can understand the cross and still miss the Savior. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The cross is on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] loves helping new believers build a strong foundation. He believes that faith is not a blind leap. It is a confident step based on evidence. He lives with his family and enjoys hiking and reading.

Coming Next: The First Foundation
If you enjoyed this journey, the next book in the series goes deeper. The First Foundation takes a 30 day look at studying Genesis to build your new faith. It is for the new believer who wants to go further.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of believers. The journey is not over. The adventure is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The New Believer Edition)

A soft, warm cream or light parchment background. A large, ancient scroll sits in the center. On the scroll, a picture of a garden is drawn. In the middle of the garden is a tree. The tree has roots, a trunk, and branches. At the base of the tree is a cross. The title FROM CREATION TO THE CROSS is in a strong, trustworthy, bold serif font. The subtitle is in a gentle, welcoming sans-serif. The overall feel is warm, inviting, and full of hope.